

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 563

By Campbell

A RESOLUTION to recognize and commend the parent coalition of Metro Nashville Public Schools for its \$5 million fundraising project to enhance school facilities at Percy Priest, Lakeview, and Paragon Mills elementary schools.

WHEREAS, parents and guardians are vital to the academic success of young students in their charge, and Tennessee is proud to be the home of so many dedicated, resourceful individuals who greatly improve student outcomes and well-being; and

WHEREAS, a coalition of Nashville parents recently partnered with Metro Nashville Public Schools (MNPS) to raise \$5 million toward upgrading existing facilities and building new ones, a feat that speaks to the power of community engagement and philanthropy in enhancing educational spaces; and

WHEREAS, the initiative was spearheaded by Shannon Martin and Katie Agnew, both parents at Percy Priest Elementary School, which was in need of a multipurpose area suited for the modern demands of schooling; and

WHEREAS, this need sparked a conversation about not just one school but about expanding this vision to benefit the entire community, and sights were set on a project to enhance gymnasiums at three elementary schools—Percy Priest, Lakeview, and Paragon Mills—that MNPS was already extensively renovating or rebuilding; and

WHEREAS, recognizing the importance of these spaces where children not only engage in physical activity but also come together for community events, the parents set a goal that seemed as immense as it was crucial: to raise over \$5 million to bring these visions to life; and

WHEREAS, through the PENCIL Foundation's support and the unwavering dedication of many local citizens, MNPS parents rallied together to meet the fundraising target in short order, within only sixty-seven days; and

WHEREAS, these new gymnasiums and multipurpose spaces are not just investments in infrastructure; they are investments in the future of MNPS children. They will serve as hubs for learning, sports, and community events, providing environments where every child can thrive; and

WHEREAS, Shannon Martin, Katie Agnew, and their fellow MNPS parents proved themselves resourceful, centering the well-being of not only their own children but that of students throughout the district; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we honor these enterprising MNPS parents for their inspirational actions; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we recognize and commend Shannon Martin, Katie Agnew, and their fellow Metro Nashville Public Schools parents for their \$5 million fundraising efforts toward enhancing and expanding school facilities at Percy Priest, Lakeview, and Paragon Mills elementary schools, expressing our gratitude for their commitment to the students of this State.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.